

INTRODUCTION

Money Problems Are Financial Opportunities

It was a Saturday afternoon in April when I was stopped on the street by an older, well-put-together woman in Beacon Hill, an upscale neighborhood in the heart of Boston. She looked like she'd lived a very good life and was enjoying this latest chapter in relative ease and comfort. I figured she was heading for a pricey lunch with some equally posh friends. Good for her, I thought. But even before she began to speak, I noticed something. She was smiling, but there was something unsettled about her expression.

We began to talk about a recent pitch she'd watched on *Shark Tank*. After a bit more conversation, she felt comfortable enough to scold me a little over an onscreen tiff I'd had with Barbara Corcoran. Then, she leaned in a little closer, changing the topic.

"I was wondering if I couldn't ask for a bit of advice from you, Kevin," she said.

Never one to shy away from sharing my opinions, I said, "Shoot." I figured she was going to ask about a stock drop or a new retirement vehicle. But her concerns were far more personal than that. She told me her husband had passed away months earlier and she was beginning to feel increasingly overwhelmed by mounting financial responsibilities, ones she'd never shouldered before. Suddenly, this woman who had lived in financial comfort into her sixties found herself having trouble getting her own credit card. Everything she had before was in her husband's name. Beyond that, she found herself in charge of paying bills for the first time, but had no idea how to